



Thathsara Rajapaksha

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Profile

First Class Honours Data Science graduate with a track record of delivering production-ready analytics solutions. I specialize in building ML systems that scale (Azure, GCP), creating dashboards that inform decisions (Power BI, Tableau), and translating complex financial data into clear insights.

Skills

PROGRAMMING & STATISTICAL ANALYSIS: Python, R, SQL, Java, MATLAB, Statistical Modeling, Hypothesis Testing, A/B Testing

DATA VISUALIZATION & BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE: Power BI, Tableau, Looker, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly, Excel (Advanced), DAX, Dashboard Development, Stakeholder Reporting

MACHINE LEARNING & AI: TensorFlow, PyTorch, Keras, Scikit-learn, Deep Learning (CNNs, RNNs, Transformers), Transfer Learning, AutoML (Optuna), Uplift Modeling, Explainable AI (SHAP), Model Optimization (Quantization, Distillation, ONNX)

GENERATIVE AI & LLMs: OpenAI GPT, Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, Meta Llama, AWS Bedrock, Hugging Face (BERT, DistilBERT, RoBERTa), RAG Architecture, Vector Databases (ChromaDB, Cosmos DB), LangChain, LangGraph, CrewAI, Prompt Engineering, Agentic AI, Model Fine-tuning (LoRA)

CLOUD & MLOPS: Azure (ML Studio, Databricks, Functions, Cosmos DB, SQL, Blob Storage, Data Factory), GCP (Vertex AI, BigQuery), AWS (SageMaker, Lambda, S3), Supabase, Docker, Kubernetes, MLflow, CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Model Registry

DATA ENGINEERING: Apache Spark, PySpark, Airflow, Kafka, Hadoop, Snowflake, MS SQL Server, PostgreSQL, Delta Lake, ETL Pipelines, Polars, Data Annotation & Labeling, Data Quality Validation & QA Testing

FULL STACK & API: Next.js, React, TypeScript, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, Zustand, Framer Motion, FastAPI, Flask, Gradio, Streamlit, REST APIs, Microservices Architecture, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Experience

AI Engineer

Feb 2025 - Feb 2026

Codebell PVT LTD, Dikwella Rd, Beliatta, Sri Lanka

- Developed end-to-end ML pipelines for production projects across computer vision, NLP, and traditional ML domains, achieving around 80% model accuracy & delivering measurable business value through cross-functional collaboration
- Optimized models for production deployment using quantization (approx. 40% size reduction), distillation, caching strategies, and implemented fairness-aware ML with bias mitigation.
- Delivered production-ready models with comprehensive documentation, collaborating with product and business teams to ensure models met stakeholder requirements and addressed ethical AI considerations

Freelance ML Engineer & Data Analyst

July 2023 - Feb 2025

- Delivered end-to-end ML solutions and statistical analysis projects for diverse clients using Python, R, and MATLAB across domains including predictive modeling, data pipeline development, and business analytics.

Customer Relations Officer

Dec 2021 - Apr 2022

LB Finance PLC, Delkanda, Sri Lanka

- Managed customer accounts and financial reporting in a fast-paced financial services environment, collaborating with cross-functional teams to resolve customer issues and demonstrating strong stakeholder engagement and problem-solving abilities under pressure

Projects

Multi-Agent Customer Retention System - Azure (Agentic AI & MLOps)

- Built an autonomous AI system using a LangGraph multi-agent architecture and Vector RAG to correlate structured SQL billing data with unstructured complaint logs, calculating dynamic churn risk scores in real-time.
- Deployed a production-ready FastAPI microservice on Azure that enables the agent to autonomously route high-risk cases to human supervisors or instantly negotiate personalized retention offers.
- Tools Used: Python, LangGraph, Google Gemini, Azure Cosmos DB, Azure SQL, Azure Blob Storage, FastAPI, Docker, OpenTelemetry.

Real-Time NBO Engine on Azure Databricks (ML at Scale & Serverless)

- Architected serverless inference layer using Azure Functions and Blob Storage with global in-memory caching, achieving sub-100ms execution latency through optimized data serialization and cost-efficient auto-scaling architecture

- Developed production-grade Next Best Offer engine utilizing Collaborative Filtering (ALS) on Azure Databricks with Apache Spark for distributed model training, enabling personalized product recommendations at enterprise scale
- Tools Used: Azure Databricks, Apache Spark, Python, ALS Algorithm, Azure Functions, Azure Blob Storage, Streamlit

E-Commerce Customer Intelligence Platform - Azure (MLOps & Business Intelligence)

- Architected serverless Medallion Architecture (Bronze → Silver → Gold) on Azure Databricks processing 100k+ e-commerce orders, achieving cost optimization through PySpark optimization and Delta Lake ACID transactions
- Delivered demand forecasting model (R^2 0.36) and ALS-based recommendation engine after strategic pivot from churn prediction, deploying MLflow-tracked models with Docker and creating Power BI "Whale Detector" dashboard identifying high-value at-risk customers
- Tools Used: Azure Databricks, PySpark, Delta Lake, Spark MLlib, XGBoost, MLflow, Power BI, Docker, Azure Data Factory

Hybrid Credit Risk Engine & Financial Explainability (Risk & Operations)

- Engineered credit scoring system processing 2.2M+ loan records with Polars streaming, reducing memory overhead by 87% (8GB to <1GB) and achieving 71% AUC with 30.5 KS statistic
- Calibrated LightGBM model to FICO-style scores (300-850) for regulatory compliance, integrating Llama 3.2 for natural language explanations of loan decisions
- Tools Used: Python, LightGBM, Polars, Llama 3.2, Streamlit, Scorecardpy

Credit Card Fraud Detection - MLOps Pipeline (Monitoring, CI/CD & Drift Detection)

- Built an end-to-end fraud detection pipeline on an imbalanced dataset (284K+ transactions, 0.17% fraud rate) using XGBoost with SMOTE, achieving 0.97+ ROC-AUC, and served real-time predictions via a FastAPI endpoint with sub-100ms latency
- Implemented automated CI/CD (GitHub Actions) for testing, linting, and weekly scheduled retraining, with MLflow experiment tracking, DVC data versioning, and Evidently AI drift detection for continuous model monitoring
- Tools Used: Python, XGBoost, FastAPI, MLflow, DVC, Docker, GitHub Actions, Evidently AI

Achievements

1st Place - DataXplore 2025 2025

- Won 1st place in a national-level Data Science competition organized by the Statistics Society of the University of Sri Jayawardenepura, competing across multiple domains including Exploratory Data Analysis, Machine Learning, Model Explainability, Time Series Analysis, and Statistical Reasoning.

Research Publication - ICACT International Conference 2025

- Published research on urban computing for sustainable university development at NSBM's 2nd International Conference on Advanced Computing Technologies (ICACT), exploring the application of IoT and machine learning to transportation systems, land use optimization, and air quality monitoring.

Top 15 Finalist - Nexora 1.0 2025

- Nextintel secured a position among the top 15 teams in Nexora 1.0 competition by developing a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) model for a university-related scenario, demonstrating proficiency in advanced NLP and LLM applications.

Education

BSc (Honours) in Data Science Apr 2022 - Nov 2025

National School of Business Management (NSBM) - Homagama, Sri Lanka

- **First Class Honours** (GPA: 3.76/4.0)
- **Coursework:** Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Big Data Analytics, Statistical Methods, Data Visualization, Cloud Computing, Natural Language Processing

GCE Advanced Level (Physical Science Stream - Mathematics) 2020

Mahinda Rajapaksha College - Homagama, Sri Lanka

Additional Courses

Azure Machine Learning Operations (MLOps) Engineer Associate (AI-300) Certification (In Progress) | Microsoft Azure Data Scientist Associate (DP-100) Certification | MLOps Specialization - Duke University | Advanced Machine Learning on Google Cloud Specialization - Google | Google Advanced Data Analytics Professional Certificate - Google | Meta Data Analyst Professional Certificate - Meta | Google Business Intelligence Professional Certificate - Google | Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst Professional Certificate - Microsoft | Deep Learning Specialization - DeepLearning.AI | Machine Learning Specialization - Stanford University

*References available upon request